



FREE GUIDE · FOR HOSPICE

The Hospice Guide to Compliant Waste Disposal.

Safely destroy unused opioids after care ends —
plus sharps and every other stream.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Unused opioids, handled right.

Hospice care leaves unused controlled substances — opioids especially — after a patient passes, in the home or the facility. Safely and promptly destroying them is both a DEA compliance duty and the single most important step in preventing diversion. This guide covers controlled-substance destruction and every other hospice waste stream.

The good news

One DEA-registered vendor gives your team a compliant way to destroy unused opioids — on-site deactivation at the bedside or mail-back — plus sharps and meds, with documentation. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Unused opioids and controlled substances after a patient passes — the defining hospice compliance issue.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Unused opioids & Schedule II–V meds
- Wasted & partial doses
- Discontinued controlled orders

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs; on-site deactivation meets non-retrievable guidance.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled / medication mail-back kit, or on-site deactivation, to DEA standards.

Tip

On-site deactivation lets you render controls non-retrievable immediately — useful when meds shouldn't leave the building.

WASTE STREAM 02

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired and unused non-controlled medications.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired non-controlled meds
- Discontinued patient meds
- Comfort-care medications

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own path)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit or on-site deactivation.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 03

Sharps

In-home and facility injection sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Injection needles & syringes
- Subcutaneous & IM sharps
- Lancets

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 04

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Wound-care and end-of-life care regulated waste.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked dressings
- Contaminated PPE
- Wound-care biohazard

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The hospice compliance checklist.

☐ Unused opioids and controls destroyed promptly — on-site deactivation or mail-back — with Form 41.

☐ A documented process for controlled-substance destruction in the home and facility.

- ☐ Injection sharps in FDA-cleared containers.
- ☐ Expired non-controlled meds destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Staff trained on safe disposal and bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS HOSPICES ASK

Your hospice questions, answered.

How do we destroy unused opioids after a patient passes?

Promptly render them non-retrievable — an on-site deactivation kit lets your team do it at the bedside, or mail them back — and document with a DEA Form 41. Prompt destruction is the key diversion-prevention step.

Can our nurses deactivate controls in the home?

Yes — on-site deactivation kits are designed for exactly this: rendering medications non-retrievable at the point of care.

What about sharps used in the home?

Prepaid mail-back sharps kits are ideal for distributed, in-home hospice care.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle equips hospice teams with on-site deactivation kits for controlled substances at the point of care, plus prepaid mail-back kits for sharps and medications — all destroyed compliantly with a Certificate of Destruction and Form 41 handled. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Unused opioids / controls	On-site deactivation or controlled mail-back (Form 41)
Expired non-controlled meds	Pharmaceutical waste kit

Waste stream	The right path
In-home sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Wound-care biohazard	Biohazard mail-back kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Hospice care is distributed — on-site deactivation and mail-back usually fit better than pickup. We'll set it up — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY HOSPICE AGENCIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your hospice waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop